JIANG NAN 江南	**Cold Chain Management**	Document No.:	IKQAP#003
		Revision No.	1
	Imperial Kitchen Group Inc.,	Effective Date:	June 28, 2026

1. Policy Statement

Imperial Kitchen Group Inc., is committed to maintaining the thermal integrity of all temperature-sensitive products. The company's "Total Cold Chain" policy ensures that high-risk foods (meat, dairy, seafood, and poultry) are kept outside of the Temperature Danger Zone at all times. Any product found to have bypassed these temperature safeguards will be deemed "adulterated" and discarded immediately.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all stages of the food flow: Receiving, Storage, Preparation, and Delivery.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Warehouse / Receiving Employees

Shall be responsible for holding the frontline for preserving the "Total Cold Chain" policy during the intake process. Upon delivery, these employees are required to manually measure and check the internal temperature of all high-risk goods, including meat, dairy, seafood, and poultry. They must strictly enforce the company's rejection criteria, ensuring that all incoming chilled goods are received at 5°C or below, and all frozen goods are at -18°C or below with absolutely no visual signs of thawing, such as ice crystals or wet boxes. Additionally, they must strictly adhere to the 15-Minute Rule, which dictates that all accepted deliveries must be moved entirely from the loading dock and safely placed into refrigerated storage within 15 minutes of their arrival.

3.2. Kitchen Captain and/or Shift Managers

Shall be responsible for handling the day-to-day execution of food safety procedures during food flow and unexpected disruptions. They are responsible for completely filling out and recording all required equipment and product temperature readings within the Daily Temperature Log. During production, they must follow the batch prepping rule, meaning they can only remove an amount of food from refrigeration that can be realistically prepared within a 30-minute window. They are also tasked with monitoring proper thawing compliance, ensuring food is only thawed inside a refrigerator at 4°C or under cold running water below 21°C as room temperature thawing is strictly prohibited. In the event of a cold chain halt or a power interruption, the team must execute swift corrective actions: items left out for less than 1 hour must be immediately stored back in the refrigerator without being refrozen ; items left out for 1 to 3 hours in a cool room below 25°C must be cooked immediately to an internal temperature of 74°C with no leftovers saved ; and any items left out for 3 hours in a hot kitchen environment above 30°C must be discarded due to high toxin risks. Finally, operations personnel are expected to immediately discard any raw materials showing advanced signs of spoilage, such as a tacky or slimy texture, or a slight odor.

3.3. Quality Assurance

Shall be responsible for the regulatory compliance, verification, and structural integrity of the food safety policy. The QA is tasked with routinely reviewing and verifying the accuracy of the Daily Temperature Logs accomplished by the operations team. They must ensure that these logs, which serve as vital legal documents, are safely retained and archived for a minimum of 12 months so they are readily available for formal audits conducted by the LGU Health Office or the FDA.

Furthermore, the QA maintains policy ownership, authoring the initial guidelines and systematically managing document updates, such as refining personnel addressing and updating corrective action provisions across policy revisions.

3.4. Maintenance Department

Shall be responsible for the physical infrastructure and constant temperature regulation of the facility's cooling units. They must ensure strict equipment standardization so that chest-type freezers and walk-in freezers continuously maintain an operating standard between -18°C and -23°C. To achieve this, the maintenance employees are required to perform routine preventative maintenance, which mandates inspecting the condenser coils and door seals of all cooling units on a strict monthly basis.

3.5. Third-Party Calibration Service

Shall acts as an independent external entity responsible for guaranteeing the technical precision of the facility's monitoring tools. This service must handle the formal equipment calibration of all digital and probe thermometers used across the operations. These calibrations must be conducted precisely once every quarter to guarantee that all tools maintain a strict operational accuracy of ±1.

4. Operational Standards

4.1. Receiving

- **Temperature Checks:** The warehouse/receiving employee must measure the internal temperature of high-risk goods upon delivery.
- **Rejection Criteria:** All chilled goods must be received at 5°C or below. All frozen goods must be received at -18°C or below with no signs of thawing (e.g. ice crystals or wet boxes).
- **The 15- Minute Rule:** Deliveries must be moved from the loading dock to refrigerated storage within 15 minutes of arrival.

4.2. Storage

The Maintenance Team shall maintain strict equipment standards to ensure constant temperature regulation.

Equipment Type	Operating Standard	Monitoring Frequency
Chest Type Freezers	-18°C - 23°C	Once daily or every shift
Walk-in Freezers	-18°C - 23°C	Once daily
Vertical Refrigerator	3°C- 5°C	Every 4 hours

4.3. Preparation and Thawing

- **Batch Prepping:** Only the amount of food that can be prepared within 30 minutes should be removed from the fridge at any one time.
- **Thawing:** Food must be thawed in the refrigerator (4°C) or under cold running water (below 21°C). Room temperature thawing is strictly prohibited.

5. Equipment Calibration

To maintain strict operational and safety standards, all digital and probe thermometers must be calibrated once every quarter to ensure an accuracy of plus or minus 1 degree. This process must be managed exclusively by a certified third-party calibration service. Alongside thermometer calibration, routine preventative maintenance must be performed on all cooling infrastructure. The maintenance team is required to conduct monthly inspections of both the condenser coils and door seals on all cooling units to ensure optimal performance and energy efficiency.

6. Corrective Action

In the event of cold chain management was halted;

Event	Action
Been less than 1 hour	Immediately store it in the refrigerator. Do not refreeze
Been 1-2 hours and room temperature is cool (<25°C)	Cook immediately. Ensure the internal temperature hits 74°C. Do not save leftovers.
Been 3 hours and room temperature is cool (<25°C)	Cook immediately. Ensure the internal temperature hits 74°C. Do not save leftovers.
Been 3 hours in a hot kitchen (>30°C)	Discard. The risk of heat-stable toxins (which cooking won't kill) is too high.
Raw material feels tacky, slimy, or has a slight odor	Discard. These are signs of advanced spoilage.
Note: These conditions shall also apply in the event of power interruption/ power shutdown. Serving spoiled food/meals violates the Food Safety Act.	

7. Verification Records

All temperature readings must be recorded in the **Daily Temperature Log** and shall be accomplished by the operations team, verified by the quality assurance. These logs are legal documents and must be kept for a minimum of 12 months for audit by the LGU Health Office or FDA.

8. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	February 12, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA/RND Specialist**	Originator
1	March 05, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA/RND Specialist**	• Change the addressing of personnel; staff members to employees • Changed store manager to restaurant and/or shift manager • Revised corrective action provision
2	May 25, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	• Added Responsibilities

	Name	Position	Signature with Date
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